Shake the Dust

By Anis Mojgani

INTRODUCTION

Charles Dickins once said: "Reflect on your present blessings, of which every man has many; not on your past misfortunes, of which all men have some." In other words, leave the past behind. Whether we like to admit it or not we all are living today with some emotional baggage. While some may have more deeply rooted baggage that affects their day to day living we can all recognize within us those times in our lives which continue to affect the way we think, our view of our self worth and the way we interact with others around us. It might have been a time when someone told you that you weren't smart enough, maybe someone commented about your looks or you made some bad choices. Whatever it is that baggage may well be holding you back from allowing you to become the person you are meant to be. Anis Mojgani, two- time National Poetry Slam winner, pays tribute to anyone who has struggled in the past and urges everyone to Shake the Dust by Anis Mojgani.

This is for the fat girls

This is for the little brothers

For the former prom queen

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And for the milk crate ball players

This is for the school yard wimps

And the childhood bullies that tormented them

Shake the dust.

This is for the benches and the people sitting upon them.

This is for the bus drivers driving a million broken hymns

And for the men who have to hold down 3 jobs,

Simply to hold up their children.

For the nighttime schoolers

And for the midnight bike riders trying to fly

Shake the dust.

For the two year olds who cannot be understood

because they speak half English and half god

Shake the dust

For the girl whose brother is going crazy

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For the gym class wall flower
And for the 12 year olds that are afraid of taking public showers
For the kid who's always late to class because he forgets the combination to his locker
For the girl who loves somebody else
Shake the dust.

This is for the hard men
Who want love, but know that it won't come
For the ones who are forgotten

For the ones whose amendments do not stand up for
For the ones who are told to speak only when they are spoken to
And then are never spoken to
Speak every time you stand
So that you do not forget yourself
Never let a moment go by that doesn't remind you
That your heart beats 100 000 times a day
And that there enough gallons of blood

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To make everyone of you an ocean

Do not settle for letting these waves settle
And for the dust to collect in your veins.
This is for the celibate pedophile who keeps on struggling

For the poetry teachers
And for the people who go on vacations alone
For the sweat that drips of a Mick Jagger singing lips
And for the shaking skirt on Tina Turners shaking hips
And For the heavens, and for the hells through which Tina has lived

This is for the tired and the dreamers
And for those families that will never be like the Cleavers
With perfectly made dinners, and songs like Wally and the Beaver
This is for the bigots
This is for the sexists

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This is for the killers
This one is for the big house jail sentenced cats
becoming redeemers
And for the springtime, that somehow always shows up
after every single winter

This is, This is for you.

Make sure that by the time the fisherman returns
You are gone
Because just like the days, I burn at both ends
And every time I write, every time I open my eyes
I am cutting out a part of myself
Just to give it to you.
So shake the dust and take me with you do

For none of this, has ever been for me
All that pushes and pulls
And pushes and pulls
Pushes for you

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So grab the world by its clothes pins
And shake it out again, and again
And jump on top and take it for a spin
And when you hop off, shake it again

For this is yours
Make my words worth something
Make this not just another poem that I write
Make it like its heavy about us all
And walk into it, breathe it in
Let it crash through the halls of your arms
Like the millions of years, of millions of poets
Coursing like blood
Pumping and pushing, making you live

Shaking the dust
So when the world knocks at your front door
Clutch the knob tightly, and open on up
Run forward into its wide spread greeting arms
With your hands before you

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Your fingertips trembling

Though they may be

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Anis Mojgani
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AWARD HISTORY

2009 National Qualifier
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